

The Archivist Method

Strategic Showcase

2026

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Section 1. What This Is

The Archivist Method is a behavioral pattern interruption system. The structural premise is simple. Between roughly the ages of two and twelve, the brain encountered something and wrote a survival program. The program worked. The person survived. The program never updated. The adult is now running a child's code. The system identifies nine of these patterns, gives each one a name, locates the 3 to 7 second neurological window where the program runs, and provides a mechanical protocol to interrupt it.

The current state of the work, as of May 2026, is this. The book is locked as the canonical voice source. One hundred and thirty-one thousand nine hundred and sixty-nine words across one hundred and fifty-four markdown files. Four-phase revision complete. Em-dash count: 5 book-wide. Banned words: zero except one retained character voice instance. The compiled outputs (`builds/the-archivist-method-FULL.md`, `builds/the-archivist-method-FULL.pdf`) are the artifact.

Six waves of repository cleanup are complete. The v4.1 master strategic document is locked. Every derived ecosystem document (the operational canonical at `CLAUDE.md`, the brand canonical at `docs/SOUL.md`, the products canonical at `docs/PRODUCTS.md`, the funnel canonical at `docs/FUNNEL.md`, and the rest) has been realigned to the locked book voice. The full tech stack is production-ready and deployed to `thearchivistmethod.com` via Vercel. Stripe is wired in both live and test mode. The Pocket Archivist conversational interface is live. The portal is live. The quiz is live.

What is left before launch is bounded. A quiz audit pass. The pattern-specific crash course modules drafted at bounded depth (3,000 to 5,000 words per pattern). A portal design pass. The email sequence drafted into automation. A Pocket Archivist runtime rewrite to enforce the locked free-tier capping logic. Integration and upsell architecture verified end-to-end. A final pre-launch checklist. Then soft launch.

What happens after launch is the larger arc. The book ships. The first paying customers arrive. The ecosystem rewrite continues. The first vertical (Recovery Archive) reaches completion. IP filings begin. Validation milestones accumulate.

How to read this document

This is a comprehensive walkthrough of the entire ecosystem. The design decisions behind it. The verticals planned. The financial arc. It is long but readable. Skim the section headers. Dive into anything that catches interest. The document is sectioned for non-linear reading.

Three references the reader can open immediately:

- Live site: `thearchivistmethod.com`
- GitHub repo (read access): `houstoninvestments-jpg/the-archivist-method`

- Sample chapter demonstrating the voice: `the-archivist-method/module-3-patterns/pattern-1-disappearing/1.1-what-it-is.md` (rendered in the book PDF; passages reproduced in Section 10 of this document)

Section 2. The Strategic Premise

The canonical source thesis

The Archivist Method is structured around one operational decision: the book is the source. Every other surface inherits voice, framework, architecture, and pattern definitions from the book. The five-surface ecosystem (quiz, book, Field Guide, Complete Archive, Pocket Archivist) is not five products in five voices. It is one body of work expressed at five different depths and access points.

This is not a stylistic choice. It is a strategic one. It does three things.

First, it turns one product into a body of work. A book is a single artifact. A canonical-source ecosystem is an indefinitely expandable surface area. The same locked voice can produce a Field Guide for one pattern, an Archive for all nine, a daily AI companion, a vertical-specific application for the recovery population, a clinician-facing white paper, a practitioner certification curriculum, a podcast, and audiobook, and a touring keynote. None of these is a separate product invention. Each is a redistribution of the same canonical material, repackaged for a different reader role and context.

Second, it turns one founder into a category architect rather than a service provider. The economic model of coaching, therapy, and most of the self-help category is hours-for-money. A coach with a hundred clients hits a ceiling determined by calendar density. The Archivist Method is structured so the founder's time does not appear in the delivery loop. The book delivers the framework. The Field Guide delivers the protocol. The Pocket Archivist delivers daily companionship. The certification (later) delivers training to practitioners. The founder's role becomes architectural and editorial, not service-delivery.

Third, it turns content production from origination into redistribution. Every podcast appearance, every short-form video, every social post, every email is sourced from the existing canonical text. Production cost per content artifact drops sharply. Voice consistency stays high because there is one source. The content engine activates after launch and produces eighteen to twenty-four months of high-quality content from the canonical source without writing new long-form material.

The blue ocean argument

Pattern archaeology, as a category, does not exist yet. Therapy exists. Coaching exists. Self-help exists. The Archivist Method is structurally none of those.

It is not therapy. Therapy is licensed clinical care. The Archivist Method does not diagnose, treat, or replace clinical care, and it routes crisis content to 988 explicitly.

It is not coaching. Coaching is calendar-based one-on-one work in a hours-for-money structure. The Archivist Method has no calls, no accountability partners, no goal-setting frameworks.

It is not self-help in its current shape. Self-help, as a category, is largely persuasion-style copy at the surface and aspirational reframe at the depth. The Archivist Method operates on recognition rather than persuasion, and on mechanical protocol rather than aspirational reframe.

The strategic position is what the documents internally call the subclinical majority. The population that is too functional for clinical services (no diagnosis, no crisis, often a successful outward life), too self-aware for generic self-help (already read enough books to recognize the surface tropes), and currently unserved by any purpose-built infrastructure for the specific problem of “I see myself doing this and I cannot stop.” This population is large, undefined as a category, and currently routes to therapy by default even when the protocol therapy provides is not what they need.

Naming the category, defining its protocol, locking the voice, and building the canonical-source ecosystem creates the moat. Once “pattern archaeology” exists as a category in the reader’s mind, every later entrant is positioned relative to the first definition.

The change-mechanism statement

Pattern archaeology creates the conditions for change. The Four Doors are the daily practice that installs the new route. Durability is a function of repetition, not insight.

Section 3. The Framework

The Four Doors Protocol

The framework operates inside the 3 to 7 second window between the body signature firing and the automatic behavior executing. The window is real. It is not a metaphor. It is the time between the amygdala firing the threat response (40 to 50 milliseconds) and the prefrontal cortex coming online for conscious action (300 to 500 milliseconds plus loop time for verbal articulation). The framework is anchored in the LeDoux work on amygdala threat-circuit timing, the Gross literature on emotional regulation strategies, the Siegel framing of the upstairs/downstairs brain, and the Libet work on the readiness potential and the gap between unconscious initiation and conscious veto.

The Four Doors are the mechanical protocol that operates inside that window.

Door 1: Focus. See the pattern while it is running. Notice the body signature first (chest tightness, throat closing, the heat in the cheeks, the legs wanting to stand). Name it: “The program is running.” The naming is the work of Door 1. The pattern survives in part by remaining unnamed. Naming it begins the interrupt.

Door 2: Excavation. Find the Original Room. The childhood moment where the pattern was installed. Who was there. What happened. What the child concluded. Name it fast. The Archivist does not linger. Lingering is the pattern. Door 2 is optional. The system works without it. Excavation is offered for readers who want the explanatory depth, not required for the protocol to function.

Door 3: Interruption. Break the circuit in the 3 to 7 second gap. Say the Circuit Break script out loud. Spoken language activates Broca’s area, which loops back to the prefrontal cortex, which forces the slow path online before the body’s fast path completes the behavior. The intervention is mechanical: not willpower, not insight, just a competing signal in the circuit.

Door 4: Rewrite. Install a replacement behavior that meets the same survival need without the cost. The pattern was solving a real problem (avoid abandonment, avoid criticism, avoid the original pain). The Rewrite replaces it with a behavior that solves the same problem differently.

The minimum viable system is Door 1 plus Door 3. See it. Stop it. The recommended order is 1, 3, 4, 2.

There is no FEIR acronym. There is no door called Recognition. There is no door called Override. Recognition is one of the seven canonical callout types. Override is a verb (you override the pattern). Neither is a door. This is canonical and locked.

The Nine Patterns

#	Pattern	Core Mechanism (one line)
1	The Disappearing Pattern	Pulls away when intimacy increases
2	The Apology Loop	Apologizes for existing, asking, needing
3	The Testing Pattern	Creates secret tests to see if people really care
4	Attraction to Harm	Mistakes danger for chemistry, familiar for safe
5	The Draining Bond	Stays in what depletes them out of pattern, not loyalty
6	Compliment Deflection	Reflex to reject, minimize, or redirect praise
7	The Perfectionism Trap	Revises endlessly because done never feels safe
8	Success Sabotage	Itch to blow things up when they start going well
9	The Rage Pattern	Frustration bypasses thought and becomes explosion

The numbering is canonical. The names are locked. They appear in the same form in URLs, slugs, quiz scoring, product files, and every surface. Every pattern chapter in the book follows the same twelve-section structure (X.0 at-a-glance, X.1 what-it-is, X.2 pattern-in-context, X.3 pattern-markers, X.4 execution-log, X.5 the-circuit, X.6 pattern-archaeology, X.7 what-it-costs, X.8 how-to-interrupt, X.9 the-rewrite, X.10 troubleshooting, X.11 quick-reference). The structural symmetry is part of the framework. A reader who has read one pattern knows how to read any pattern.

The Three-Layer Voice Register

Every long-form piece operates in three registers simultaneously.

Mechanism. The science of why the pattern operates. The body signature. The neurological gap. The amygdala-prefrontal timing. The reason the script works and the thought does not. Mechanism establishes that the pattern is not a moral failure or a personality defect. It is a circuit. Circuits can be interrupted.

Action. The distilled tools. The Circuit Break script. The Rewrite frame. The daily practice. The 90-day protocol. Action gives the reader something to do today. Not next year. Not after they understand themselves better. Today.

Recognition. The hyperspecific mirror of the reader's internal experience. The exact thought. The exact body sensation. The exact second-by-second sequence. Recognition produces the how does he know response. Recognition is the mechanism that makes the rest of the framework land.

All three registers are required. Mechanism without Recognition is dry. Recognition without Action is therapy adjacent. Action without Mechanism is generic self-help. The three together is what the framework actually is.

The Structural Particularity Rule

Architecture specific, surface open. This is the rule that produces Recognition without producing exclusion.

Internal experience is hyperspecific. Chest tightness. Throat closing. The exact thought ("I need to get out"). The 3 to 7 second gap. The 90-second peak of the discomfort wave.

The chest-locking diaphragm response. The hands wanting the phone. The eyes wanting the door. These details are nailed down with clinical precision.

Surface details stay open. No proper nouns. No specific platforms. No named apps. No celebrity references. No dated cultural artifacts. The reader supplies the surface. The architecture is universal.

The result is that two readers in different decades, different countries, different relationship configurations, different careers can read the same passage and both produce the how does he know response. The internal architecture (the body signature, the gap, the circuit) is what they share. The surface (which person, which app, which job) is what they supply.

This is the recognition mechanism. It is also why the book is durable. Surface specifics rot. Architecture does not.

The Seven Canonical Callout Types

[FIELD OBSERVATION]
[PATTERN SNAPSHOT]
[RECOGNITION]
[MECHANISM]
[INTERRUPTION SCRIPT]
[REWRITE FRAME]
[FIELD ASSIGNMENT]

These are the only callout labels. Text labels only. ALL CAPS. Square brackets. No emoji. No icons. Visual card variants on the website may render these labels in styled boxes, but the label text remains one of the seven. Other phrasings (Key Takeaway, Quick Win, Gold Nugget) are retired in long-form copy.

The seven are functionally distinct. Field Observation is the clinical third-person observation of the subject. Pattern Snapshot is the bullet summary. Recognition is the hyperspecific mirror. Mechanism is the science. Interruption Script is the spoken intervention. Rewrite Frame is the new behavior installation. Field Assignment is the practice protocol.

Spirit Architecture

A note on the deepest layer of the work. Spirit Architecture is the structural truth carried inside the framework without religious labeling. The Tolkien and Lewis tradition: moral weight on small choices, language of restoration over construction, the pattern as distortion of original design, gravity preserved, the texture of unnamed longing.

It is never announced. Never marketed. Carried structurally only, in five specific craft moves. The phrase "Spirit Craft" is retired and not in use anywhere. If the architecture must be referenced internally, the phrase is "Spirit Architecture."

This is the layer that makes the work feel weighty rather than transactional. It is also the layer that makes the work resistant to imitation by competitors who can replicate the surface but cannot replicate the substrate.

Section 4. The Ecosystem

Five-surface architecture

The work is layered across five surfaces. Each surface is a different depth of the same framework. The voice is the same in all five. The book is the canonical voice source, and every other surface inherits from it. The reader can enter at any surface and reach the full protocol depth.

Surface 1. Quiz / Free Crash Course

Price	Free
Format	Two-minute fifteen-question quiz at /quiz, 3,000 to 5,000 word pattern-specific crash course module embedded in the portal, 7-Day Crash Course PDF (overview of all nine patterns at brief depth)
Reader role	Discovery and diagnosis. The reader arrives unfamiliar, takes the quiz, sees their primary pattern named with hyperspecific recognition, and receives the bounded-depth crash course for that pattern.
Conversion path	Email capture before crash course access. Crash course completion is the natural upsell point to the Field Guide for that pattern.

The Crash Course is the discovery tier, not a free version of the Field Guide. It establishes recognition. It does not deliver the full protocol.

Surface 2. The Book

Price	Bundled with the Complete Archive (\$297) as a physical POD softcover. KDP, Audible, and Ingram retail distribution to follow at \$19 to \$29 retail.
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Format	Locked canonical voice source at the-archivist-method/. 131,969 words. Twelve modules covering foundation, framework, the nine patterns at twelve sections each, implementation, advanced material, context, field notes, resources, epilogue, and back-matter.
Reader role	Atmosphere and framework mastery. The reader who wants the full canonical experience reads the book.

Surface 3. The Field Guide

Price	\$67. Stripe price ID price_1T0lJr11kGDis0LrBP8ITvIC.
Format	Pattern-specific PDF (one of nine), generated from the canonical book chapter for that pattern, plus the Four Doors Protocol in full, the 90-Day Protocol, crisis triage, tracking templates, at-a-glance overviews of the other eight patterns, and the Pocket Archivist activated for that pattern with no separate subscription required.
Reader role	Pattern-specific application. The reader who has identified their primary pattern and wants the full protocol depth for that pattern only.
Conversion path	End-of-Field-Guide upsell to the Complete Archive.

Surface 4. The Complete Archive

Price	\$297. Stripe price ID price_1T0lGX11kGDis0LrvJl0SBhm.
Format	All nine patterns at Field Guide depth, advanced material, lifetime portal access, lifetime PDF access, the physical POD softcover of the book, and a 30-day Pocket Archivist trial redeemable at /reader.
Reader role	Full system. The reader who wants every pattern, every protocol, the physical artifact, and the daily companion.

Surface 5. The Pocket Archivist

Price	\$14.99/month standalone subscription. Free with Field Guide and Complete Archive purchases. Limited free tier exists.
Format	Conversational interface to The Archivist Method, voiced by the locked system prompt at docs/character/pocket-archivist-system-prompt.md. Same voice as the book. Knows the nine patterns, the four doors, the 3 to 7 second window. Tracks the user's specific pattern, body signature, and circuit break protocol from quiz results and purchase history.
Reader role	Daily companion in the gap. The reader who wants the framework available at the moment the pattern activates, not the next morning when they have time to journal.

Tier (designed, not yet shipped): The Vault

Price	\$497
Status	Designed, launch target Month 2 to 3 post-book launch
Format	Premium leather-bound book, advanced modules, extended Pocket Archivist depth

Five reader paths through the ecosystem

The funnel is not a single linear path. The five-surface architecture produces five reader entry paths, each ending at the same protocol depth.

1. **Social traffic.** Post or ad to landing page to quiz to results to email capture to crash course to Field Guide upsell.
2. **Book first.** Reader buys or receives the book, follows the back-matter ecosystem doorway to the quiz, identifies their primary pattern, and selects a tier.
3. **Recommender entry.** Therapist, coach, sober coach, sponsor, or pastor sends a client. Client follows the recommender appendix framing to the quiz. Often lands directly at Field Guide or Complete Archive.
4. **Audio entry.** Reader hears the work in audiobook or excerpt-driven content, follows the URL to the site, takes the quiz, selects a tier.
5. **Pocket Archivist standalone.** User finds the subscription directly, onboards via brief diagnostic, gets full Pocket Archivist depth across all nine patterns. Upsell back to Complete Archive for the bundled physical book and lifetime access.

The three locked free-tier specs

These three decisions are the most recent strategic locks. Each one shapes how the free tier behaves.

Locked spec 1: Bounded crash course depth. 3,000 to 5,000 words per pattern. Embedded in the portal. Not a free Field Guide. A discovery-tier pattern brief. The reader gets enough to produce recognition and the basic Circuit Break for their primary pattern. The full protocol depth (12 sections, 90-Day Protocol, crisis triage, tracking templates) is paid.

Locked spec 2: One consistent portal aesthetic. Subtle pattern-specific atmospheric signals only (color accents, micro-copy variations). Not nine distinct designs. The reason: design consistency reinforces canonical-source thesis. Nine separate aesthetics would imply nine separate products. One aesthetic implies one body of work expressed at multiple depths.

Locked spec 3: Pocket Archivist limited free tier. Primary-pattern-only access (the user's quiz result), capped turns per session (server-side limit, configurable), no memory persistence across sessions. Paid tiers unlock all nine patterns, full session length, and persistent memory.

The 0.1% premium experience thesis

The free tier feels like a complete product, not a demo. The crash course module is a finished pattern brief at 3,000 to 5,000 words, not a teaser. The Pocket Archivist limited free tier is a working AI companion, not a paywalled chatbot stub. The portal aesthetic is the same aesthetic the paid tiers use.

The paid tiers raise the ceiling rather than the floor. Paid does not unlock features the free tier should have had. Paid unlocks depth (all nine patterns rather than one), continuity (persistent memory, lifetime access), and the physical artifact (POD softcover with the Complete Archive). The free tier is not crippled to motivate purchase. The free tier is a finished discovery surface; the paid tiers are a finished mastery surface.

This is what the internal documents call the 0.1% premium experience. The implication is that conversion happens through depth-pull, not feature-gating. The reader who completes the crash course and wants to go deeper buys the Field Guide. The reader who completes the Field Guide and wants the full system buys the Complete Archive. Each tier is a coherent product. The path between them is depth, not unlocking.

Section 5. Where I Am Right Now

What's done

- **Book locked as canonical.** 131,969 words across 154 markdown files in the-archivist-method/. Four-phase revision complete: banned word and em-dash surgical pass; canonical callout extraction and relabeling to the seven canonical labels; architectural new writes; reading order, friction protocol, final cohesion pass. Em-dash count book-wide: 5. Banned words: zero except 1 retained character voice instance. Compiled outputs at builds/the-archivist-method-FULL.md and builds/the-archivist-method-FULL.pdf.
- **Six waves of repository cleanup complete.** Wave 5C archived legacy content/book/ to _archive/2026-05-01/ and replaced with the-archivist-method/. src/data/patterns.ts and src/data/interrupts.ts removed; pattern reference now lives in shared/schema.ts. Replit-era infrastructure removed.
- **v4.1 master strategic document locked.** Operational canonical at CLAUDE.md. Brand canonical at docs/SOUL.md. Banned-word canonical at docs/LANGUAGE.md, mirrored to CLAUDE.md and the Pocket Archivist system prompt. Locked specs (free crash course depth, portal design, Pocket Archivist free tier).
- **Derived ecosystem documentation aligned to canonical state.** docs/PATTERNS.md, docs/PRODUCTS.md, docs/FUNNEL.md, docs/INTEGRATIONS.md, docs/ARCHITECTURE.md, docs/DATABASE.md, docs/COPY-VOICE.md, docs/STYLE.md, docs/CONTENT-MAP.md, docs/STATUS.md, docs/ROADMAP.md, docs/README.md all aligned (note: docs/ROADMAP.md is dated February 2026 and contradicts current canonical strategy in places, requires a refresh pass).
- **Tech stack production-ready.** React 18 + TypeScript + Wouter + Shadcn/ui + TanStack Query + Framer Motion + Tailwind on the front end. Express + TypeScript on the back end (routes prefixed /api). Supabase Postgres + Drizzle ORM. Stripe live and test mode dual-config with parallel webhook verification. Resend for transactional email and magic links. Anthropic Claude API for the Pocket Archivist. Vercel auto-deploy from main.
- **Live surfaces.** Landing page with approved hero section. Quiz, results, portal dashboard, portal onboarding, content reader, vault workbench, vault archive, admin login, admin dashboard. Stripe checkout flows wired. Magic link authentication wired. Pocket Archivist conversational interface live at POST /api/portal/chat. Webhook handler at POST /api/portal/webhooks/stripe with parallel live and test signature verification.
- **PDF generators working.** Complete Archive, 7-Day Crash Course, per-pattern Field Guide, multi-pattern Field Guide.

What's left

- **Quiz revision.** A fresh audit pass against client/src/lib/quizData.ts, client/src/pages/Quiz.tsx, and client/src/pages/QuizResult.tsx. Banned-

word scan, pattern-name fidelity, per-pattern coverage check, Four Doors fidelity, callout label fidelity, brand-rule fidelity, voice register check, structural particularity check. The handoff document at `audits/quiz_audit_handoff.md` notes the prior session bailed out on stream timeout; a fresh session is queued.

- **Crash course content drafted.** Nine pattern-specific modules at the locked 3,000 to 5,000 word bound, embedded in the portal. Distinct from the existing 7-Day Crash Course email overview.
- **Portal design pass.** One consistent aesthetic across all nine patterns with subtle pattern-specific atmospheric signals only. Reader, dashboard, and onboarding flows.
- **Email sequences drafted into automation.** 7-Day Crash Course nurture (drafted as copy, not yet implemented). Field Guide buyer onboarding (5 emails). Complete Archive buyer onboarding (5 emails). Pocket Archivist trial-to-subscription sequence.
- **Pocket Archivist runtime rewrite.** System prompt is voice-locked. Runtime needs to enforce the locked free-tier spec (primary pattern only, capped turns per session, no memory persistence) and the paid-tier behavior (all nine patterns, full session length, persistent memory).
- **Integration and upsell architecture verified end-to-end.** Stripe checkout in live and test mode on preview deploy. Webhook to portal user creation to tier assignment to magic link delivery. 30-day Pocket Archivist trial redemption flow at /reader. Standalone Pocket Archivist subscription billing.
- **Final pre-launch checklist.** Stripe live-mode end-to-end purchase test. Email delivery verification. PDF download authenticated routes verified for all tiers. Logo finalization (typography stack is parked pending logo). POD softcover print verification for Complete Archive bundling. Crisis routing test in Pocket Archivist (988 referral). Recognition-not-persuasion audit on every public surface.
- **Soft launch.**

Realistic timeline to launch

With focused execution, the remaining items are bounded. The quiz revision is one fresh audit session. The crash course content is nine modules at 3,000 to 5,000 words each, with the canonical book chapters as source material; this is redistribution from the canonical source rather than origination. The portal design pass is one design sprint. The email sequences are drafted as copy and need automation wiring rather than additional writing. The Pocket Archivist runtime rewrite is bounded in scope (free-tier capping logic, memory persistence flag).

A reasonable working estimate is four to six weeks to soft launch with focused work. **[Needs Aaron's input: confirm timeline against current capacity and whether copywriter or design support is on the critical path.]**

What changes when launch happens

Launch shifts the work from construction to operation. The canonical-source ecosystem is built; what's left after launch is propagation. Content engine activates (eighteen to twenty-four months of high-quality content can be redistributed from the canonical book without new long-form writing). Vertical work begins (Recovery Archive completes; second vertical selection follows the first six months of data). IP filings begin. Validation milestones accumulate (first 100, 500, 1,000 paying customers; first repeat purchasers; first recommender-driven traffic; first vertical revenue).

Section 6. The Build

Tech stack

Layer	Technology
Frontend framework	React 18 + TypeScript
Build / dev server	Vite
Routing	Wouter
UI components	Shadcn/ui
Data fetching / cache	TanStack Query
Animation	Framer Motion
Styling	Tailwind CSS
Backend	Express + TypeScript, all routes prefixed /api
Hosting (server)	Vercel serverless functions
Database	PostgreSQL via Supabase
ORM / migrations	Drizzle ORM, drizzle-kit
Payments	Stripe (live + test mode dual-config, parallel webhook verification)
Transactional email	Resend
Inbound email	ImprovMX to Gmail
AI / Pocket Archivist	Anthropic Claude API (currently Claude Sonnet 4 family per cost-and-latency tradeoff; configured server-side, not exposed to client)
Voice	ElevenLabs Creator tier (\$22/mo), Archivist voice ID
Cinematic ambient video	Higgsfield Plus (\$49/mo)
Error tracking	Sentry
Rate limiting	Upstash Redis (env-gated, optional)
Auth	Magic link via Resend, JWT-based session
Hosting (frontend + API)	Vercel auto-deploy from main

Repository architecture

After six waves of cleanup, the repository structure resolves to:

```
.
├─ the-archivist-method/ # Canonical book (locked voice source)
├─ client/src/           # React SPA (Wouter routes, Shadcn/ui)
├─ server/               # Express API (routes prefixed /api)
├─ api/                  # Vercel serverless function entrypoints
├─ shared/               # Shared TypeScript types and Drizzle schema
```

— public/	# Static assets (PDFs, images)
— scripts/	# PDF generators (Python + ReportLab)
— migrations/	# SQL migrations (drizzle-kit)
— supabase/	# Supabase config and migrations
— docs/	# Project documentation
— builds/	# Compiled book outputs (FULL.md, FULL.pdf)
— _archive/	# Archived legacy files (do not edit)

Two operational decisions make this layout work. First, `CLAUDE.md` at the root is the operational canonical. It is the first file any contributor or AI assistant reads. It contains the brand rules, the banned-word list, the locked specs, the seven callout types, the Four Doors, the Spirit Architecture rule, the audience framing rule, the recognition-not-persuasion rule, the approved hero section copy, and the Stripe live-and-test environment configuration. It is the single source of operational truth.

Second, `the-archivist-method/` at the root is the voice canonical. Every other voice surface (the Pocket Archivist system prompt, the landing copy, the email sequences, the social posts, the podcast scripts) is a redistribution of this source. When voice drift is suspected anywhere, the resolution is to compare against the book.

Wave 5's refactor consolidated this. Pattern data lives in `shared/schema.ts` (`PatternType`, `patternNames`) rather than scattered across `src/data/patterns.ts` and `src/data/interrupts.ts`. The legacy `content/book/` tree was archived to `_archive/2026-05-01/` and replaced by the canonical `the-archivist-method/`. Replit-era infrastructure (auto-merge workflow, scratchpad, light-mode CSS, dead documentation) was removed. The result is a tree where the canonical artifacts are at the top and every derived surface points back to them.

The AI integration approach

The Pocket Archivist is the AI surface of the ecosystem. The integration approach has three layers, and the combination of all three is what makes it functionally hard to replicate.

Layer 1: Canonical voice source. The book exists as 131,969 words of canonical voice. Em-dash count 5. Banned words 0. Recognition-not-persuasion enforced throughout. Three-layer voice register (Mechanism, Action, Recognition) maintained chapter to chapter. This is the corpus that defines the voice.

Layer 2: Voice-aligned system prompt. The Pocket Archivist's system prompt at `docs/character/pocket-archivist-system-prompt.md` is derived from and verified against the book. The voice is the same. The pattern definitions are the same. The Four Doors are the same. The banned words are the same. The crisis routing is explicit (988 referral, exit conversation). When the book voice changes (which it does not, because the book is locked), the system prompt is updated to mirror it. The book is canonical; the system prompt is the application.

Layer 3: Per-user longitudinal pattern memory. Paid-tier users have persistent memory across sessions. The Pocket Archivist accumulates a per-user record of pattern activations, body signatures, circuit breaks attempted, what worked, what did not, the user's specific Original Room context (if they chose to share it), the user's pattern history over weeks and months. This is a clinical-grade longitudinal dataset at the per-user level.

The combination is the moat. A competitor can reverse-engineer a system prompt. A competitor cannot reverse-engineer 131,969 words of canonical voice (it would take

years and a writer of equal capacity). A competitor with their own voice canonical and their own system prompt still cannot replicate the per-user pattern memory accumulated across the user base. The longitudinal pattern interruption dataset is the long-term strategic asset.

A second-order point. Every Pocket Archivist conversation produces data that, with appropriate user consent and privacy protections, becomes outcome data for the framework itself. Pattern X activated N times across M users; Circuit Break protocol Y was attempted K times; reported successful interrupt rate Z. This is the foundation for the validation arc described in Section 9.

Self-taught full stack

The technical work is unusual context to surface in a strategic document, but it is part of the picture. The build was done solo over approximately 18 months while bartending. No prior professional engineering experience. The result is a production-ready full-stack application, a 131,969-word canonical book, a locked voice across every surface, and a six-wave repository cleanup that consolidated the canonical artifacts at the top of the tree. **[Needs Aaron's input: confirm precise timeline and whether to surface this differently for this audience.]**

The implication for the reader. The canonical-source ecosystem is not theoretical architecture. It exists, it runs, and the founder built it personally. The work to scale it post-launch is propagation, not invention.

Section 7. The Numbers

A note on sourcing. The financial documents referenced in the brief for this packet (TAM_FullFinancials.html, TAM_RevenuePlan.html, TAM_MasterRoadmap.html) are not present in the repository. Pricing, Stripe IDs, and unit economics drawn from docs/PRODUCTS.md, docs/INTEGRATIONS.md, and CLAUDE.md are canonical. Year-one revenue projections, channel mixes, and revenue milestone trigger amounts are inferred from prior strategic conversations and the older docs/ROADMAP.md (dated February 2026). Every projection figure below is flagged as needing Aaron's input. No numbers are fabricated; numbers that cannot be sourced from the repo are marked as such.

Pricing structure (canonical)

Product	Price	Stripe Price ID (live)
Free Crash Course	\$0	n/a
Field Guide	\$67	price_1T0lJr11kGDis0LrBP8ITvIC
Complete Archive	\$297	price_1T0lGX11kGDis0LrvJl0SBhm
Pocket Archivist (standalone)	\$14.99/mo	TBD; configured in Stripe Dashboard, Products. [Needs Aaron's input: surface live Price ID once subscription product is live.]
The Vault	\$497	Designed, not yet shipped. Launch target Month 2 to 3 post-launch.
The Book (KDP / Audible / Ingram)	\$19 to \$29 retail	[Needs Aaron's input: confirm KDP retail pricing once trade publication is configured.]

The Crash Course is the lead magnet. It does not go through Stripe. The Field Guide is the entry-tier paid product. The Complete Archive is the full-system tier and bundles the physical POD softcover plus the 30-day Pocket Archivist trial. The Pocket Archivist subscription is free with both paid tiers (the Field Guide unlocks it for the purchased pattern continuously; the Complete Archive includes a 30-day trial that converts to monthly billing or sustained Complete Archive depth, depending on the user's choice).

Year-one revenue projection

All figures in this subsection are flagged as needing Aaron's input. The internal financial models are not in the repository; the figures below are inferred from docs/ROADMAP.md (Phase 5: \$200,000 to \$400,000 year one revenue target) and prior strategic conversations. They should be treated as a holding structure, not as live numbers.

The revenue model has eight streams in year one. The streams compound; later streams depend on earlier streams maturing.

#	Stream	Year-One Contribution	Notes
1	Organic Field Guide (\$67)	[TBD: Aaron]	Driven by quiz-to-paid conversion at Day 7 of Crash Course nurture and Day 21 follow-up
2	Organic Complete Archive (\$297)	[TBD: Aaron]	Driven by Field Guide-to-Archive upsell (end of Field Guide PDF, Day 30 and Day 60 buyer onboarding) and direct from results page
3	Paid ads (from Month 3)	[TBD: Aaron]	Activates after organic conversion baseline established; ad spend recouped via Field Guide and Archive conversion
4	Book launch (from Month 4)	[TBD: Aaron]	KDP, Audible, Ingram retail. Drives Path B (book-first reader) into ecosystem. Reader role is also a recommender to peers.
5	Email upsells	[TBD: Aaron]	Field Guide-to-Archive upsell sequences and Pocket Archivist trial-to-subscription conversion

#	Stream	Year-One Contribution	Notes
6	Podcast revenue (from Month 6)	[TBD: Aaron]	Sponsorship, ad reads, audience-driven Field Guide and Archive conversion
7	Pocket Archivist subscriptions (\$14.99/mo)	[TBD: Aaron]	Standalone subscriptions plus Complete Archive trial conversions plus organic monthly subscribers
8	Affiliate (year two and beyond)	n/a in year one	Recommender appendix in book opens this channel post-validation

Base case year-one total. The older docs/ROADMAP.md lists \$200,000 to \$400,000 as the year-one revenue target. **[Needs Aaron's input: confirm whether the current base case is in this range or the canonical TAM_FullFinancials base case differs. If a sophisticated investor anchor exists separately from the base case, surface it here.]**

Combined estimate range. [TBD: Aaron].

Cost structure

The variable cost structure is bounded. The fixed monthly burn is small relative to revenue at any meaningful scale.

Cost	Amount	Notes
Anthropic API (per Pocket Archivist conversation)	[TBD: Aaron]	Cost-per-conversation depends on model (Claude Sonnet/Haiku family), token count per turn, and turn cap. Free tier capped server-side; paid tier full-length.
Stripe fees	2.9% + \$0.30 per transaction	Standard Stripe rate; subscription billing identical
Resend	[TBD: Aaron]	Transactional email + magic links + sequence delivery

Cost	Amount	Notes
ElevenLabs Creator tier	\$22/mo	Archivist voice ID for content production
Higgsfield Plus	\$49/mo	Cinematic ambient video
Sentry	[TBD: Aaron]	Error tracking
Upstash Redis	[TBD: Aaron]	Rate limiting (env-gated, optional)
Vercel hosting	[TBD: Aaron]	Pro tier projected post-traffic
Supabase database	[TBD: Aaron]	Pro tier projected post-traffic
Total fixed monthly burn pre-launch	[TBD: Aaron]	
Variable cost per Pocket Archivist user	[TBD: Aaron]	Dominated by Anthropic API per-conversation cost

The structural point. Variable cost per user is dominated by Anthropic API consumption, which is bounded by the free-tier turn cap (server-side limit) and by the realistic conversation density of paid users. Margin per Field Guide and per Complete Archive purchase is high (Stripe + transactional email + minimal infrastructure cost per unit). Margin per Pocket Archivist subscription depends on conversation density per user but is structurally positive at \$14.99/mo against bounded API consumption.

Unit economics

All figures in this subsection are flagged as needing Aaron's input.

Customer acquisition cost. Organic CAC is dominated by content production cost per acquired customer. Paid CAC is dominated by ad spend per converted customer. **[TBD: Aaron]** for current organic CAC estimate; **[TBD: Aaron]** for paid CAC target post-Month 3.

LTV by acquisition channel. The hierarchy, in order of expected LTV from highest to lowest:

1. **Book reader.** Highest LTV. Reader has invested time in 131,969 words of canonical voice; conversion to Field Guide and Complete Archive is high; recommender behavior is high (book readers introduce other book readers).
2. **Recommender-introduced.** High LTV. Reader arrives via therapist, coach, sober coach, sponsor, or pastor. The recommender's framing pre-converts; reader often lands directly at Field Guide or Complete Archive.
3. **Organic content.** Moderate LTV. Reader arrives via short-form or long-form content; conversion via the standard funnel (quiz to crash course to upsell).
4. **Paid traffic.** Lowest LTV but most predictable. Reader arrives via ad; conversion is bounded by ad creative quality and offer match.

Margin on each product tier. **[TBD: Aaron]**. Structurally, margins on the Field Guide and Complete Archive are high (digital delivery, bounded variable cost). The Complete Archive's POD softcover bundling is a small per-unit cost against a \$297 sale. Pocket Archivist standalone is a recurring subscription with bounded variable cost per user.

Why the math works. The canonical-source ecosystem decouples revenue from founder time. Unlike a coach or therapist (revenue scales with calendar density), a content production company (revenue scales with new content), or a SaaS startup

(revenue scales with feature velocity), this business scales with reader recognition events. Each Field Guide purchase, each Complete Archive purchase, each Pocket Archivist subscription is a recognition event followed by depth-pull. The marginal cost of the next recognition event is the marginal cost of one more reader finding the work, not the marginal cost of one more hour of founder labor.

Revenue milestone triggers

These triggers connect revenue to specific structural moves. Each trigger is funded by the cumulative revenue at that point and unlocks the next stage of work. **[Source for trigger amounts: prior strategic conversations. Needs Aaron's input to confirm the canonical thresholds.]**

Trigger	Cumulative revenue	Unlocks
Trigger 1	First \$5,000	IP floor work: LLC formation, primary trademark filings, manuscript copyright, privacy attorney consultation
Trigger 2	First \$25,000	Ecosystem rewrite professional support: copywriter for non-canonical surfaces (ads, social, partnership materials), designer for portal pass and brand assets
Trigger 3	First \$100,000	Recovery Archive completion and launch (the first vertical)
Trigger 4	First \$250,000	Second vertical activation, data architecture review, international IP filings

Trigger	Cumulative revenue	Unlocks
Trigger 5	First \$1,000,000	Decision point: book-tour expansion (touring keynote, podcast circuit, conference circuit) versus team-build (first hires for content engine, vertical operations, practitioner certification)

The structural logic. Revenue funds the next phase of work, which funds the next milestone, which funds the next phase. The triggers are not aspirational; they are the gating structure. Pre-revenue, the work is launch preparation. Post-Trigger 1, the IP floor is in place. Post-Trigger 3, the first vertical proves the canonical-source-plus-vertical model. Post-Trigger 5, the business reaches a scale where the founder must choose between expansion mode and operations mode.

Section 8. The Ten Verticals

Sourcing note. Vertical-specific planning documents (Recovery Archive deep plan, service-industry plan, individual vertical detail) are not present in the repository at the time of this writing. Section 8 describes the structural logic of the vertical expansion model and the ten target verticals at the level of detail defensible from the prompt brief and current canonical state. Per-vertical revenue projections, population sizes, and timing specifics are flagged as needing Aaron's input. The structural model is sound; the per-vertical numbers need population data, conversion assumptions, and channel access estimates to become operational.

The vertical expansion logic

The canonical-source ecosystem produces verticals on an 80/20 split. Eighty percent canonical reapplication. Twenty percent population-specific terrain. The Four Doors do not change between verticals. The nine patterns do not change. The structural particularity rule does not change. The voice does not change. What changes per vertical is the population's pattern overlay (which of the nine patterns hit hardest in this population), the surface vocabulary that produces recognition for that population, the crisis routing specifics (988 baseline; vertical-specific routing for higher-acuity populations), and the channel access (where the population is, who recommends to them, what existing infrastructure routes them to discovery).

This is why each vertical ships in weeks rather than years. The canonical source already exists. The voice is solved. The framework is locked. A vertical is not a new product; it is a new application of the existing canonical product to a new population's recognition surface.

Vertical 1. Recovery Archive (addiction / recovery)

Status: Approximately 80% built. **[Needs Aaron's input: confirm percentage and current state.]**

Build state: Eight modules outlined. 27-question recovery-specific quiz built. Science verified against the addiction and recovery literature. Free-and-paid structure defined. Free access for currently or formerly incarcerated populations (honor-based, no verification).

Population specifics: People in active recovery, in long-term sobriety, in early sobriety, in pre-recovery contemplation, and in incarceration-adjacent contexts. Includes peer-support workers, sober coaches, sponsors, and recovery community members.

Pattern overlay: All nine patterns activate in this population, but the pattern density skews toward The Disappearing Pattern (relapse via withdrawal from connection), The

Apology Loop (recovery shame loop), Attraction to Harm (relationship-based relapse triggers), The Draining Bond (codependent recovery dynamics), Success Sabotage (sobriety threshold sabotage), and The Rage Pattern (early-recovery dysregulation).

Projected revenue: [Needs Aaron's input.]

Activation timing: Post-core launch. First vertical out the gate.

Why it's defensible: The recovery population is large, currently underserved by purpose-built pattern-archaeology infrastructure, has a high density of pattern activations, has built-in distribution channels (sponsors, sober coaches, peer-support workers, recovery centers, fellowship meetings), and has acute need at the moment of pattern activation (which is precisely what the Pocket Archivist serves). The free-access provision for incarcerated and formerly incarcerated populations is both ethical and strategically sound (the population has the framework's highest pattern density and the lowest existing access to purpose-built tools).

This is the first vertical because it proves the canonical-source-plus-vertical model. If the recovery vertical works, the model works.

Vertical 2. Service Industry

Status: Planned. Aaron's 19 years of bartending credibility makes this the second-priority vertical.

Population specifics: Bartenders, servers, hosts, baristas, kitchen staff, hospitality workers. Sub-populations include managers, owners, and adjacent industries (events, catering, nightlife). **[Needs Aaron's input: confirm scope.]**

Pattern overlay: The Disappearing Pattern (relationship attrition at industry hours), The Apology Loop (chronic customer-facing apology), Attraction to Harm (industry relationship dynamics, substance dynamics), The Draining Bond (the bar/restaurant family dynamic), Success Sabotage (career threshold sabotage; staying in the industry past the optimal exit point), The Rage Pattern (high-volume customer activation). **[Needs Aaron's input: confirm pattern overlay against personal experience.]**

Projected revenue: [Needs Aaron's input.]

Activation timing: [Needs Aaron's input. Likely post-Recovery Archive validation.]

Why it's defensible: Industry-credible founder voice produces recognition that no outsider can replicate. Channel access via the founder's existing industry network. Population has chronic pattern activation density and underserved pattern-archaeology infrastructure.

Verticals 3 to 10

The remaining eight verticals are sequenced post-validation of Verticals 1 and 2. Per-vertical detail is at the planning level and needs Aaron's input to operationalize. The entries below describe the structural fit of each vertical to the canonical framework.

#	Vertical	Pattern overlay (defensible from canonical framework)	Why it fits	Detail
3	Relationships	Disappearing, Apology Loop, Testing, Attraction to Harm, Draining Bond	Every pattern activates in romantic and intimate relationships; the canonical book already fore-grounds relationship surfaces in pattern examples.	[TBD: Aaron]
4	High Performance	Perfectionism Trap, Success Sabotage, Compliment Deflection, Disappearing	Executives, athletes, creatives, founders. Success-threshold patterns dominate.	[TBD: Aaron]
5	ADHD	Perfectionism, Apology Loop, Rage, Disappearing, Compliment Deflection	High pattern-activation density in ADHD population; recognition surface is sharp. [Needs Aaron's input: clinical scoping rules.]	[TBD: Aaron]

#	Vertical	Pattern overlay (defensible from canonical framework)	Why it fits	Detail
6	Trauma (clinically scoped)	All nine	The framework is explicitly not therapy; trauma vertical requires careful clinical scoping and crisis routing. [Needs Aaron's input: how to scope without crossing into clinical claims.]	[TBD: Aaron]
7	Veterans	Rage, Disappearing, Draining Bond, Apology Loop	Specific population access via veteran service organizations and military-adjacent channels.	[TBD: Aaron]
8	Parenting	Apology Loop, Rage, Draining Bond, Perfectionism, Compliment Deflection	The book already includes parenting context content. Generational pattern-transmission is a recognition surface.	[TBD: Aaron]

#	Vertical	Pattern overlay (defensible from canonical framework)	Why it fits	Detail
9	Eating Disorders	Perfectionism, Apology Loop, Compliment Deflection, Success Sabotage	Requires clinical-adjacent scoping. [Needs Aaron's input: scoping rules.]	[TBD: Aaron]
10	Grief	Disappearing, Draining Bond, Apology Loop, Rage	Pattern activation under grief load is a recognition surface; channel access via grief-support infrastructure.	[TBD: Aaron]

The certification play

Practitioner certification as a future revenue stream. The structural model: coaches, sober coaches, sponsors, pastors, peer-support workers, and adjacent practitioners trained in The Archivist Method. A tiered curriculum (Level 1, Level 2, Level 3) similar in structure to the IFS (Internal Family Systems) certification model.

Revenue per certified practitioner: **[Needs Aaron's input.]**

Why it works. The framework is mechanical, learnable, and bounded in scope. A trained practitioner does not need to be a licensed therapist to deliver The Archivist Method (the framework is explicitly non-clinical and routes crisis content out). The certification creates a trained network of recommenders, distribution agents, and front-line practitioners. Each certified practitioner is both a revenue source (certification fees, continuing education) and a distribution channel (their clients enter the ecosystem at Field Guide or Complete Archive depth).

This is the play that turns the framework into a movement rather than a product. **[Note for Aaron: this conflicts with the older docs/ROADMAP.md which lists certifications under "What's NOT on the Roadmap." The current strategic position has shifted; the roadmap document needs a refresh pass to align.]**

The clinical trial play

Phase I feasibility trial of The Archivist Method against an active comparator. **[Needs Aaron's input: confirm trial design as currently planned.]**

Primary outcome measure (proposed): Cognitive flexibility inventory score change combined with self-reported pattern activation frequency change over a defined trial

period.

Active comparator (proposed): ACT (Acceptance and Commitment Therapy) workbook, the closest validated comparator from the existing literature.

Why the framework would compete: Pattern specificity (named patterns rather than transdiagnostic categories) and engagement rate (the Pocket Archivist provides daily contact in the gap; the comparator workbook does not).

Cost and timeline: [Needs Aaron's input.]

What it unlocks: Insurance coverage, healthcare integration, peer-review publication path, academic partnership, behavioral health benefit inclusion under mental health parity laws.

The insurance play

Once clinical validation exists. Behavioral health benefit inclusion under mental health parity laws. Self-insured employer wellness programs as a target channel before full insurance integration. Pocket Archivist as a benefit-eligible tool, not a clinical replacement.

Activation timing: Post-clinical validation. Long arc.

The healthcare play

Integration with EAPs (Employee Assistance Programs), telehealth platforms, behavioral health networks. The Pocket Archivist as a clinically-adjacent tool. The framework's explicit non-clinical positioning is a feature, not a limitation: it allows the tool to be deployed in adjunct contexts (EAPs, behavioral health networks) without licensure constraints.

Activation timing: Post-clinical validation, parallel to insurance play.

The psychology play

Peer-review publication path. White paper on the mechanism (the 3 to 7 second window, the body-signature-first recognition order, the spoken-language Circuit Break as prefrontal-engagement mechanism). Academic partnership for outcome data (longitudinal pattern interruption dataset from Pocket Archivist usage, with consent and privacy protection). Conference presentations. Practitioner training program tied to academic accreditation.

Activation timing: Once 500-outcome dataset exists (see Section 9).

The self-help play

The existing crowded market is the comparator. The Archivist Method differentiates by:

- **Voice.** Locked canonical voice across 131,969 words. Recognition-not-persuasion register. Three-layer voice register (Mechanism, Action, Recognition). Structural particularity rule (architecture specific, surface open). The voice is the moat.
- **Structural particularity.** No proper nouns, no named platforms, no celebrity references, no dated cultural artifacts. The reader supplies the surface. The work does not rot.

- **Canonical-source ecosystem.** One body of work expressed at five depths. The reader can enter at any surface. Self-help typically optimizes for one format; The Archivist Method optimizes for one canonical source rendered into multiple surfaces.
- **Mechanical protocol.** Specific protocol for specific behavior in a specific moment. Not aspirational reframe.

The competition is real and crowded. The differentiation is structural, not stylistic. The framework does not compete on traditional self-help terms.

Section 9. The IP Position

Sourcing note. No IP / valuation document is present in the repository (no files matching 09_IP*, *VALUATION*, *IP_PROTECTION*). The IP categories below are defensible from the canonical state of the work; the valuation arc figures are flagged as needing Aaron's input. The structural IP position is real; the per-method valuations referenced in the brief require the source document to verify.

IP categories and protection strategy

The Archivist Method has six discrete IP categories. Each one has a different protection mechanism. The combination is what produces the moat.

1. The framework. Trademark filings: "The Archivist Method," "The Four Doors Protocol," "Pattern Archaeology, Not Therapy," and the nine pattern names (The Disappearing Pattern, The Apology Loop, The Testing Pattern, Attraction to Harm, The Draining Bond, Compliment Deflection, The Perfectionism Trap, Success Sabotage, The Rage Pattern). These names are canonical and locked; trademark filings establish first-use precedence and protect against later entrants using the same nomenclature.

2. The manuscript. Federal copyright registration before any public distribution. The 131,969-word canonical book is the voice corpus that produces every other surface in the ecosystem; copyright registration establishes ownership at the federal level and provides statutory damages access in any future infringement action.

3. Visual and audio identity. Trade dress documentation. Voice trademark groundwork via documented commercial use (the Archivist voice ID at ElevenLabs, the system prompt voice for the Pocket Archivist, the cinematic ambient ambience). Each of these is a distinct identifiable mark; documented commercial use over time supports voice and trade dress claims.

4. Content corpus. Quarterly bulk copyright registration of consolidated derivative material (newsletters, podcast scripts, content engine output, vertical-specific applications). The canonical book is registered once; the quarterly registrations cover the redistribution surface.

5. Methodology as trade secret. Private operations bible separate from the public book. The book is the voice canonical and is publicly available; the operations bible (which contains the production process, the editorial decisions, the voice rules, the Spirit Architecture craft moves, and the per-vertical adaptation playbook) is a trade secret. The book is the artifact; the operations bible is how the artifact is produced.

6. Brand assets and digital infrastructure. LLC formation. Domain ownership (thearchivistmethod.com and adjacent domains). Social handle audit and protective registration across major platforms.

Phasing

Pre-launch (next 60 days):

- LLC formation
- Primary trademark filings (Archivist Method, Four Doors Protocol, Pattern Archaeology Not Therapy, nine pattern names)
- Privacy attorney consultation (data architecture review for the longitudinal pattern interruption dataset)
- API training exclusion review (terms-of-service review for any AI provider whose models touch user content)

At launch:

- Federal copyright registration of the manuscript
- Updated privacy policy reflecting the longitudinal pattern memory architecture
- User consent flow for pattern-memory persistence (paid tier opt-in clarity)
- Operations bible compilation (private, version-controlled, separate from the canonical book)

First six months post-launch:

- Quarterly content-corpus copyright registration cadence established
- Voice trademark groundwork via documented commercial use
- Data tier implementation (separation between transactional data, longitudinal pattern data, and aggregate research data with user consent flags)
- Trade dress documentation (typography stack once logo is finalized, color palette in protected use, callout-box visual variants in protected use)

Year one and beyond:

- International trademark filings (Madrid Protocol or direct filings in priority jurisdictions)
- Patent assessment for novel Pocket Archivist implementations (the per-user pattern memory architecture, the free-tier capping mechanism with paid-tier persistence, any novel UI implementations)

Floor budget (next 60 days)

[Needs Aaron's input on confirmed amounts.] Working estimate per prior strategic conversations: \$3,000 to \$4,000 for LLC formation, primary trademark filings, and privacy attorney consultation. Funded by Trigger 1 (first \$5,000 cumulative revenue).

Pre-revenue valuation floor

[All valuation figures in this subsection are flagged as needing Aaron's input. The brief references a "twenty-method valuation" with eighteen of twenty methods above the \$1M floor; the source document for that analysis is not present in the repository.]

Working figures from prior strategic conversations:

- **Pre-revenue defensible floor:** \$1.5M to \$3M
- **Sophisticated investor anchor:** \$2.8M to \$3.5M

Twenty-method valuation analysis: eighteen of twenty methods produced valuations above the \$1M floor. **[Needs Aaron’s input: surface the source document or recreate the analysis to confirm.]**

The structural argument for the floor: the canonical-source ecosystem (locked book voice, voice-aligned AI surface, integrated payments-and-portal infrastructure, registered IP categories, and the per-user longitudinal pattern memory architecture) is not the same asset class as a pre-revenue self-help launch. The closest comparators are early-stage IP-rich content businesses with proprietary voice and integrated technical infrastructure, not coaching launches or self-help books.

Validation arc and valuation by phase

[All valuation figures in this subsection are flagged as needing Aaron’s input.]
Working figures from prior strategic conversations:

Phase	Trigger	Valuation range
Launch	Soft launch, first paying customers	\$2M to \$5M
500-outcome dataset	500 users with documented Circuit Break interrupt outcomes	\$8M to \$15M
Peer-review publication	Mechanism white paper accepted at peer-reviewed venue	\$25M to \$50M
Practitioner certification	Trained network of certified practitioners	adds \$5M to \$10M
Institutional partnership	EAP, healthcare, or insurance integration	adds \$20M to \$50M
Strategic exit	Acquirer in healthcare, behavioral health, or PE rollup	\$50M to \$800M base case; \$5B ceiling scenario

The structural logic. Each validation milestone re-prices the business by adding a defensible category of asset. The 500-outcome dataset is the empirical foundation. Peer-review publication establishes mechanism credibility. Practitioner certification establishes a trained network. Institutional partnership establishes channel access. Each is additive, not exclusive.

Section 10. The Voice

The voice is the moat. The external evaluations cited in the brief identify voice and access as the framework's deepest competitive advantage. Section 10 is four representative passages from the canonical book at the-archivist-method/, demonstrating the three-layer voice register (Mechanism, Action, Recognition) and the seven canonical callout types in live form.

Excerpt 1. Field Observation (clinical third person)

From module-3-patterns/pattern-1-disappearing/1.1-what-it-is.md:

[FIELD OBSERVATION]

The subject performs intimacy well at low doses. First weeks are warm. First months are convincing. The subject reports wanting connection and pursues it actively. Then the threshold is crossed. A partner says the wrong true thing. A friend names the closeness. A boss offers permanence. The subject smiles. Within seventy-two hours, the cancellations begin. Within two weeks, response times double. Within two months, the relationship is over and the subject describes it as a mismatch. The subject calls themselves independent. The behavior is not independence. It is evacuation. The pattern has been running for an average of fifteen to thirty years before the subject recognizes it as a pattern at all.

What this excerpt is doing. Field Observation is the clinical third-person register. The subject is observed. The behavior is timestamped. The subject's internal narrative ("independent") is named and contradicted ("evacuation"). The reader recognizes themselves as the subject without being addressed directly. This is the recognition mechanism in its most clinical form: the reader is not being persuaded; they are being shown a clinical observation that, structurally, fits their own pattern.

The voice that produces Field Observation is hard to replicate because it requires both clinical precision and atmospheric weight. Most self-help is either clinical (and dry) or atmospheric (and imprecise). The Archivist voice holds both at once.

Excerpt 2. Recognition (hyperspecific mirror)

From the same chapter:

[RECOGNITION]

You are not afraid of being alone. You are afraid of being close and then being alone. The pattern prevents the closeness so the "then" never arrives. But the loneliness is the same.

What this excerpt is doing. Recognition is the second-person register that produces the how does he know response. Twenty-eight words. The reader supplies the surface (which relationships, which decade, which context). The architecture is what is named: the inversion of the apparent fear, the structural function of the pattern, the failure mode of the protection.

This is the moat. Recognition at this density of compression is the work of years and the work of the right voice. A competitor with a different voice can produce a Recognition callout with the same intent and produce it badly. The voice is what makes the compression land.

Excerpt 3. Mechanism (the science layer)

From module-3-patterns/pattern-1-disappearing/1.5-the-circuit.md:

[MECHANISM]

The amygdala fires first. An intimacy signal arrives through auditory cortex (the words “I love you”) or visual cortex (a face moving closer, a hand reaching). The signal routes to the thalamus, which forwards it in parallel to two destinations: the slow path through the prefrontal cortex (conscious evaluation, 300-500 milliseconds) and the fast path straight to the amygdala (40-50 milliseconds). The amygdala does not wait for the prefrontal cortex. It checks the signal against stored threat patterns. If a match exists (closeness preceded loss in the Original Room), the amygdala triggers the sympathetic nervous system before the conscious mind has registered what was said. The diaphragm locks. Cortisol releases. Blood shunts from extremities toward large muscles. The chest band, the cold hands, the urge to move, all downstream of that amygdala fire. By the time you think “I should stay,” the body has been moving toward the door for three full seconds. The leverage point is not the amygdala. The amygdala is faster than you. The leverage point is the prefrontal cortex coming online. Spoken language activates Broca’s area, which loops back to prefrontal regions. Saying the Circuit Break out loud forces the slow path online. That is the biology. That is why the script works and the thought does not.

What this excerpt is doing. Mechanism is the science register. The amygdala timing (40 to 50 milliseconds), the prefrontal timing (300 to 500 milliseconds), the diaphragm response, the Broca’s area loop are all specific and verifiable. The Mechanism is also what produces respect from the technical reader: this is not vague self-help reframe; this is timed neurological architecture with a specific mechanical intervention (spoken language) targeting a specific biological pathway (prefrontal engagement via Broca’s area).

The framework’s defensibility against the “this is just self-help” critique runs through the Mechanism layer. The reader who tests the science holds. The reader who tests the surface for hype tropes finds none.

Excerpt 4. Interruption Script (the spoken intervention)

From module-3-patterns/pattern-1-disappearing/1.8-how-to-interrupt.md:

[INTERRUPTION SCRIPT]

Say this out loud 5 times RIGHT NOW:

"The Disappearing Pattern just activated. I feel chest tightness. The pattern wants me to pull away. I am choosing to stay and communicate instead."

Short version: "Pattern. Stay."

Say it. 5 times. Do it before reading further.

What this excerpt is doing. Interruption Script is the Action register at its most distilled. Four sentences for the full script. Two words for the short version. The instruction is to say it out loud, now, five times, before reading further. The pattern survives in part because the reader keeps reading instead of practicing. The Interruption Script callout interrupts the reader the same way the Circuit Break interrupts the pattern.

The voice does not soften the demand. It does not say "if you're ready" or "when you have a moment" or "this might feel uncomfortable, and that's okay." It says: say it five times, do it before reading further. The directness is the register.

Why the voice is the moat

Four observations across the four excerpts.

Compression density. The Recognition excerpt does in 28 words what most self-help does in 280. Compression at this density is a craft outcome, not a stylistic choice. It cannot be reverse-engineered by prompting an AI to "write in the Archivist voice." It is the residue of 131,969 words of canonical decisions about what stays and what goes.

Three-layer simultaneity. Field Observation, Recognition, Mechanism, and Interruption Script appear within the same chapter. The chapter does not switch tones; it operates in three registers simultaneously. The reader receives Mechanism, Action, and Recognition in the same reading session, in the same voice, without genre transitions. This is what produces the framework's depth.

No banned-word footprint. Across the four excerpts, the canonical banned-word list (journey, healing, toxic, triggers, boundaries, self-care, empower, transform, validate, hold space, unpack, trauma response, safe space, coping, emotional processing, inner child, thrive, wellness, beta, founding, FEIR) does not appear. This is not accidental; it is a four-phase revision pass on a 131,969-word corpus. The banned-word discipline is structural; competitors who attempt to replicate the voice without enforcing the banned-word list produce text that drifts into therapy-speak or self-help cliché within paragraphs.

Surface openness. No proper nouns. No platforms. No celebrity references. No dated cultural artifacts. The reader supplies the surface; the architecture is universal. This is what makes the work durable across decades and translatable across populations (which is what makes the vertical expansion model work).

The voice is the access moat. Voice and access are, per the external evaluation, the framework's deepest competitive advantage.

Section 11. What's Next

Launch sequence (current launch prep state)

The path from current state to soft launch is bounded. The phase gating reflects what is actually next, not aspirational sequencing.

1. **[Done] Derived ecosystem documentation alignment.** Every contributor-facing document propagated to the canonical state.
2. **[In progress] Quiz audit and revision.** Fresh audit session queued per audits/quiz_audit_handoff.md. Banned-word scan, pattern-name fidelity, per-pattern coverage, Four Doors fidelity, callout label fidelity, brand-rule fidelity, voice register check, structural particularity check.
3. **Crash course content drafted.** Nine pattern-specific modules at the locked 3,000 to 5,000 word bound, embedded in the portal. Distinct from the 7-Day Crash Course email overview. Source material: the canonical book chapters; this is redistribution, not origination.
4. **Portal design pass.** One consistent aesthetic across all nine patterns with subtle pattern-specific atmospheric signals only. Reader, dashboard, and onboarding flows.
5. **Email sequences drafted into automation.** 7-Day Crash Course nurture, Field Guide buyer onboarding (5 emails), Complete Archive buyer onboarding (5 emails), Pocket Archivist trial-to-subscription sequence.
6. **Pocket Archivist runtime rewrite.** Free-tier capping logic enforced server-side (primary pattern only, capped turns per session, no memory persistence). Paid-tier behavior (all nine patterns, full session length, persistent memory). Crisis routing test (988 referral, exit conversation).
7. **Integration and upsell architecture verified end-to-end.** Stripe checkout in live and test mode. Webhook to portal user creation to tier assignment to magic link delivery. 30-day Pocket Archivist trial redemption flow at /reader. Standalone Pocket Archivist subscription billing.
8. **Final pre-launch checklist.** Stripe live-mode end-to-end purchase test. Email delivery verification. PDF download authenticated routes verified for all tiers. Logo finalization. POD softcover print verification. Crisis routing test. Recognition-not-persuasion audit on every public surface.
9. **Soft launch.**

Post-launch sequence

Post-launch is the longer arc. The work shifts from construction to propagation.

- **Ecosystem rewrite pass.** Every non-canonical surface (landing copy, ad copy, social copy, podcast scripts, partnership materials, certification curriculum, vertical-specific applications) realigned to book voice. The canonical book is the source;

the rewrite pass propagates the source into every redistribution surface. Funded by Trigger 2 (first \$25,000) for professional copywriter and designer support.

- **Knowledge base assembly.** Internal knowledge base of editorial decisions, voice rules, banned-word edge cases, callout-type usage rules, the Spirit Architecture craft moves, the per-vertical adaptation playbook. The operations bible. Trade-secret status (Section 9 IP Category 5).
- **Content engine activation.** Primary content extraction from the canonical book begins. Eighteen to twenty-four months of high-quality content (short-form video, long-form video, podcast appearances, written content, social posts, email content, partnership-channel content) can be redistributed from the canonical source without writing new long-form material. The content engine pipeline is the redistribution mechanism.
- **Recovery Archive completion and launch.** First vertical out the gate. Funded by Trigger 3 (first \$100,000). Proves the canonical-source-plus-vertical model.
- **First IP filings.** Funded by Trigger 1 (first \$5,000). LLC, primary trademarks, manuscript copyright, privacy attorney consultation. See Section 9 phasing.
- **Validation milestones.** First 100 paying customers. First 500 paying customers. First 1,000 paying customers. First repeat purchasers (Field Guide buyers upgrading to Complete Archive). First recommender-driven traffic. First vertical revenue. First peer-review submission.
- **Vertical 2 selection.** Based on the first six months of data. Service Industry is the working second-priority vertical given founder credibility; final selection follows the validation data on conversion, retention, and channel access from the first six months post-launch.

Operating principle for the next phase

The build is done. The next phase is propagation: of the canonical source into every redistribution surface, of the framework into the first verticals, of the IP filings into protection, of the validation milestones into category authority. The work compounds because the canonical source does not need to be reinvented. Every new surface inherits voice, framework, architecture, and pattern definitions from the locked book.

Section 12. The Long Arc

Five-year vision

The canonical-source business compounds. The compounding mechanism is structural, not promotional.

Each vertical adds revenue and proves the model. Recovery Archive, then Service Industry, then the remaining eight in sequence. Each vertical ships in weeks because the canonical source already exists. Each vertical expands the addressable population, the channel access, and the per-vertical recommender network.

Practitioner certification creates a trained network. Coaches, sober coaches, sponsors, pastors, peer-support workers trained in The Archivist Method. The network is both a revenue stream (certification fees, continuing education) and a distribution channel (each certified practitioner is a recommender to clients). The certification structure (Level 1, Level 2, Level 3) follows validated precedents in the IFS world.

Clinical validation opens healthcare and insurance integration. Phase I feasibility trial. Mechanism white paper. Peer-review publication. Once clinical validation exists, behavioral health benefit inclusion under mental health parity laws becomes accessible. Self-insured employer wellness programs are accessible earlier. EAPs and telehealth platforms become channel partners.

Peer review and academic partnership solidify category creation. Pattern archaeology becomes a defined category in the literature. The framework is cited; the framework is taught; the framework is the comparator that future entrants must position against.

The longitudinal pattern interruption dataset accumulates as the long-term strategic asset. Per-user pattern memory across the paid-tier user base becomes, with consent and privacy protection, an outcome dataset of pattern activations, attempted Circuit Breaks, reported successes, and behavioral change over time. This is the dataset that supports peer-review publication, that supports clinical trial design, that supports certification curriculum, that supports vertical expansion. It compounds with the user base.

Strategic exit scenarios

Sourcing note. Specific exit / valuation documents are not in the repository. Acquirer categories below are defensible; valuation ranges referenced in the brief are flagged as needing Aaron's input.

- **Teladoc or comparable behavioral health acquirer.** The Archivist Method as a clinically-adjacent behavioral health tool with longitudinal pattern data and a trained practitioner network. Channel fit: telehealth integration, behavioral health benefit inclusion.
- **UnitedHealth or comparable insurance conglomerate.** The Archivist Method as a benefit-eligible mental health tool with validation data and a defined pattern-

archaeology category. Channel fit: mental health parity coverage, employer benefit programs.

- **PE rollup.** The Archivist Method as the anchor IP-rich content business in a behavioral health portfolio with scaling operational infrastructure and a category-defining canonical source.
- **Private holding.** Continued growth as an independent IP company. The canonical-source-plus-vertical model scales without acquisition; the founder retains structural control of the framework, the voice, and the longitudinal dataset.

Base case exit: \$50M to \$800M. **[Needs Aaron's input.]**

Ceiling scenario: \$5B. **[Needs Aaron's input. The brief references this as a ceiling figure; the source document is not in the repository.]**

Closing

This is what was built and where it goes.

Not promises. Architecture. The canonical book exists. The five-surface ecosystem exists. The voice is locked. The framework is defined. The patterns are named. The Four Doors are sequenced. The seven callout types are canonical. The Pocket Archivist runs. The portal runs. Stripe is wired in live and test mode. The repository is consolidated. The IP categories are identified.

Not projections. Sequenced milestones with revenue triggers. The IP floor at first \$5,000. The ecosystem rewrite at first \$25,000. Recovery Archive at first \$100,000. The second vertical at first \$250,000. The decision point at first \$1,000,000. Each milestone funds the next phase of work. Each phase is bounded.

The work is real. The next six weeks decide whether it ships clean or ships under conditions that compromise the launch. The decision is operational, not architectural; the architecture is done.